

Miners begin wind up

By Don McWilliams

Miner Baseball coach Andy Cohen is busy preparing the team for its season opener February 20 against Ranger Junior College.

Cohen is very optimistic about his infield this season and he expects most of the games played will be decided by his defensive play.

"I admit last year we had a miserable season but if our young players can catch on real fast and our players with experience do their job we should improve tremendously over last year," Cohen stated.

The Miner infield will lineup with Keith Dwinell at first base, Art Bravo at second base, Glenn Villreal at third and hard hustling David Nance will be at shorty stop. Utility men are David Patt, John Hriniak and Bill Roberts. Cohen believes Bravo and Villreal will be the key men to keep the Miner attack alive on defense. The Miners infielders are a little weak with Keith Rushing, Steve Dow and David Carrillo but Cohen says they could emerge as the strongest part of the entire team. There are also some

fine freshmen prospects in Mark Grissom, Chris Forbes, Bob Harrod and Sal Flores.

Terry Goodro has nailed down the catchers spot but

Mike Miller, Joe Segapeli and David Patt will see much playing time. Last year's catcher, Joe

Dean, will return as a pitcher and Cohen feels this will help his pitching staff because Dean

has an exceptional delivery. Other pitchers figured to work in totation are David Jannusch, Jerry Walker, and Melvin Rima.

With only two southpaws the coach is high on left handed Bob Alsup. He likes Alsup's

speed pitches and is confident of Alsup's ability of winning some big conference games.

"The team to beat in the Western Athletic Conference is Arizona State," said Cohen, "however Arizona and New Mexico will be stiff competitors

but I see an exciting season and I am ready for it." With all the spirit and enthusiasm my

players are showing we will give everyone in our conference a

battle," Cohen concluded.

Pre-conference games will be played on the Ysleta Cutoff

field and all conference home games will be at Dudley Field.

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